

Staff Commendations

May 2026

Elyse Webb, Sarah Schock, Patty Morris, Gena Pierce, Heather Caron, Kellee Andrews, Katie Gilbert, Britany Fetrow- Thank you all so much for your support and help with our Kindergarten Parent Night. Your collaboration, flexibility, and willingness to work with our students and families helped make the evening such a success. We truly appreciate the time, effort, and care you put into making it a welcoming and positive experience for everyone.

-South Prairie KDG Team

I would like to recognize Amanda Dornsbach, Patty Mrzena and Cindy Nelson. These three show up to work everyday with a positive attitude and are willing to do whatever they can to support even our most challenging students. They are kind, and build great relationships with the students they work with. Their hard work does not go unnoticed and I am so thankful they are at Oak View.

-Kasey Roberts

5th Grade ELA- Amanda Christiansen, Trisha Gurnsey, Barb Kellner, Michaela Peters, Austin Rix and Katie Johnson: Thank you all for always being willing to have conversations that can be uncomfortable as we navigate our new curriculum. I appreciate that you all put students first and do what is best for all of our kids to be successful and learn to the best of their abilities. You truly make coming to work each day fun.

-Stacy Heidemann

Holly Foarde, Sabrina Morua, and Sara Jones: Thank you for advocating for our shared students and working together to provide supports and structure for our friends. You are all amazing at what you do and I am blessed to work with you all.

-Stacy Heidemann

Sam Galvin: Thank you for all you do for our kids. You are willing to jump in and help everyone, are calm and responsive to the needs of not only your student, but others as well, and see the good in everyone. You have come into our building and been a positive light. I appreciate you!

-Stacy Heidemann

To the K-12 Music Department (Joy Augustine, Sarah Bosen, Becca Cassel, Eric Garringer, Lisa Maifeld, Eric Mohlis, Avery Nabholz, Steve Britt, Bonnie Ihde, Suzi Royer, and Heidi Steger): Thank you all for your work and collaboration as a Music PLC throughout year three of the curriculum review cycle. It's been really great to see how this team has grown as a K–12 group and how your work together continues to move things forward in a positive way. I truly appreciate the time, effort, and thought everyone has put into this process. I'm looking forward to continuing this work together as we head into the 2026–2027 school year.

-Ashton Reams

I want to recognize Lisa Maifeld because she is simply an amazing teacher. 3rd and 4th-grade just finished their performances, and it was so clear how much hard work she and the students put into it. Mrs. Maifeld's passion for music is incredible, and the best part is how that passion rubs off on the kids—she truly gets them excited to learn and perform. We are so lucky to have a teacher who cares this much and makes music so much fun for our students!

-Lacey Sedrel

Jeff Cain: Thank you for stepping up to provide instruction in a new and innovative way! Your willingness to try something new is commendable! Thank you for all you do for DCG students every day!

-Alyson Finley

Brooke Pfaltzgraff: Thank you for being a leader in the district and for working tirelessly to support students at DCE! I appreciate your willingness and desire to step into something new next year!

-Alyson Finley

Stephanie Rupp: Thank you for your hard work supporting Medicaid reimbursement for the district. You are so organized and responsive, which has been incredibly helpful in managing the Iowa Medicaid Review process. You are the best!

-Alyson Finley

I would like to nominate Brynn Hansen. She is a talented teacher, a team player and always has a kind word and a smile on her face to share with both students and coworkers. She is such an asset for our school!

-Ronda McCarthy

I would like to nominate Amanda Davison. She has tremendous talent in building incredible classroom culture and trusting relationships with her students. Her talent as a teacher shines through in everything she does. We are lucky to have her here!

-Ronda McCarthy

I would like to recognize my fellow North Ridge Encore teammates: Sarah Bosen, Amanda Erps, Kellen Sulentic, Adam Jones, and Brandon Fitch. It is such a joy to work with this group of educators, whether we are collaborating to plan an assembly, brainstorming ways to support students, or just sharing about our weekends. I am blessed to come to work each day and be a part of this team!

-Betsy Bejarno

I want to give a big shoutout and thank you to Patty Morris. I am not sure if she is aware of this or not, but she has been consistently finding ways to remind me that I am doing a good job and I am worthy to hold my position. This year my mental health has taken a hit and if I did not have an admin like Patty, I don't think I would've been able to accomplish as much. It's like her special spidey sense. Any time I was feeling low or questioning myself, Patty would swoop in and compliment me on some of the most minor thing possible (ie. I updated our agenda doc or something like that) and it would just be the quick switch or even distraction to snap me back into a more positive mindset. Patty has been an amazing leader and mentor for me in my three years at SP and DCG and I couldn't be more thankful for her.

-Logan Wilson

I want to shoutout Elyse Webb for all of her leadership and collaboration with our academic and behavior MTSS processes. Elyse has been a key contributor to fine tuning our programs and processes, and has been an extremely helpful listening ear when I am needing to talk something out loud to get feedback. She is always willing to jump in and help with a solution-focused lense, and I couldn't be more thankful for her guidance this school year.

-Logan Wilson

I'd like to give a big thank you to Brandon Fitch! Brandon has been a huge help to me this school year when I was finding myself dealing with a bunch of sickness and absences (more than I've ever dealt with in my 7 years in education). He was more than willing to step in and cover my classes or check in with a student when I was gone. He has been a phenomenal collaborator and teammate!

-Logan Wilson

Emily Donovan has been a HUGE asset to DCG and myself! She is always willing to meet with me to brainstorm ways to better support students and help me revamp our programs, along with giving me great ideas on how to improve lessons and interventions for the next school year. She has been amazing to work with and I am very thankful for her knowledge and guidance!

-Logan Wilson

A huge shout out to Patty Morris for making Teacher Appreciation Week the best for the staff at South Prairie. Lots of effort went into the week.....thank you!

-South Prairie teachers

We wanted to give a shout out to Neva Guidebeck to say thank you for coming to the 4th grade music concert. It truly meant so much to our students to see you there supporting them. Your presence showed how much you care, and it did not go unnoticed. The relationships you build with the students on your bus make a real difference in their day, and coming to their concert was such a meaningful way to go above and beyond. Moments like that help students feel valued, seen, and proud of their hard work. Thank you for all that you do each day—not just getting students safely to and from school, but for the kindness and connection you bring to their lives.

-Lindsey Updike, Sarah Newcomb, Chloe Lester, & Mallory Spray

I would like to nominate Adam Juhl for a School Board Accommodation. In his role as Assistant Activities Director, one of Adam's responsibilities is coordinating transportation requests for all DCG fine arts and athletic activities. While this may sound simple, it requires constant communication, organization, and coordination with directors, coaches, and the transportation department. Adam has performed this role almost flawlessly in his first year, which is incredibly impressive. Through proactive planning, consistent follow-up, and exceptional attention to detail, he helped coordinate and support more than 500 trips during this school year. No one is perfect, but from my perspective, Adam came very close in year one. His professionalism, reliability, and commitment to supporting students and staff greatly contributed to the smooth delivery of transportation services throughout the school year.

-Jeff Wolfe, Transportation Director

I would like to thank **Brooke Pfaltzgraff** for her hard work, collaboration, and unwavering dedication to her students, especially in challenging situations. She is an exceptional teacher, colleague, leader, and mother. Brooke cares deeply for her students and supports them unconditionally, always going above and beyond to help them grow and become successful. Her commitment and compassion make a lasting impact on everyone around her.

-Deb Cale

I would like to thank **Aly Finley** for her continued support as we have navigated challenging situations the past few months. She consistently makes herself available whenever questions or concerns arise, and her student-centered approach is deeply appreciated. Aly always keeps the needs of students at the forefront while ensuring staff have the support and resources necessary to help students succeed. Thank you, Aly, for your ongoing guidance, support, and dedication.

-Deb Cale

I would like to celebrate **Klaire Jungling** for her professionalism and exceptional organization in maintaining the important data and documentation needed to support her students. She is truly a superstar! Klaire balances compassion and kindness with strong structure and routines that help create stability and success for her students. She is an excellent communicator and meticulous record keeper, ensuring that her instructional decisions are thoughtful, purposeful, and grounded in data. Klaire's students and families are lucky to have her.

-Deb Cale

*I would like to thank **Bekah Frisk** for her kind, caring, and compassionate nature and for the incredible ways she supports and cares for her student each day. She consistently demonstrates patience and calmness, even in challenging situations, and serves as an inspiration to those around her. Our team is truly fortunate to have Bekah and the positivity and dedication she brings to our school community.*

-Deb Cale

I'd like to thank the South Prairie teachers, associates, and staff that contributed work to our staff art show as part of our school's annual Fine Art Show. This part of our event is always popular and it couldn't happen without you. Thank you for supporting the arts at South Prairie!

-Maddison Maddock

I'd like to recognize Lacey Sedrel for her ongoing and incredible support of South Prairie's Art Show - this event truly could not happen at this scale without you!

-Maddison Maddock

I'd like to recognize the Encore team at South Prairie for another year of support, care, and encouragement they provide. Such an amazing team to work with!

-Maddison Maddock

I'd like to thank Paige Carl for her constant support. She took the time to write artist compliments to every student in her class during the art show at a time of year when I know many teachers are tired and stressed. She is always quick to support her colleagues and I appreciate her!

-Maddison Maddock

Thank you Elyse Webb for your support in getting our school ready for the art show - whether that be passing out work, tracking down students, or letting me take over your room :) I appreciate your willingness to help in so many different ways!

-Maddison Maddock

To Molly Sorenson, Claire Marchant, Abie Chavez, Patty Morris, Lacey Sedrel, Chris Nash, Elyse Webb - thank you so much for agreeing to take part in our art video! Going on camera is no easy thing - thank you for stepping out of your comfort zone!

-Maddison Maddock